DETACHMENT — HORUS HERESY (30K)

GLORIOUS MARTYRDOM

WORD BEARERS (HH, TRAITOR) | WARHAMMER 40,000 | 11TH EDITION

Glorious Martyrdom is a fully homebrew Detachment for the Word Bearers (XVII Legion) faction — a Horus Heresy-era Traitor Legion detachment adapted to the Warhammer 40,000 11th-edition Detachment framework, built from the real HH3e Word Bearers Rite of War data. Formatted to match the No Figure Left Behind Combat Patrol archive.

FACTION ABILITY

ZEALOTRY OF THE FAITHFUL
Faith does not care whether the guns are still firing. Each time a friendly Word Bearers unit is Battle-shocked, that unit's Objective Control characteristic is not reduced to 0.

DETACHMENT RULE

GLORIOUS MARTYRDOM
Detachment Points: To use this detachment you must spend 1 DP.

Every company keeps at least one believer willing to stand in the way of the bullet meant for someone else. Once per battle, each time an enemy unit is selected to shoot a friendly Word Bearers unit, before any Hit rolls are made, you can select one model in that Word Bearers unit: until that attack has been fully resolved, all wounds allocated by that attack must be allocated to the selected model.

FORCE DISPOSITIONS
This detachment has access to the following Force Disposition: Take and Hold.

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

Included: All homebrew Word Bearers (HH) roster units (Lorgar Aurelian, Argel Tal, Erebus, Kor Phaeron, Zardu Layak, Gal Vorbak, Ashen Circle, Mhara Gal Dreadnought, Diabolist, Procurators, Phraetus Anointed Conclave, Inductii Squad), and any homebrew Legiones Astartes (HH) unit from the generic Space Marines (HH) roster given the Word Bearers Trait.

Excluded: Any other Legion's Primarch or named characters. Non-Legiones-Astartes allies, per standard HH3e Legion-purity convention.

ENHANCEMENTS

RELIC OF THE UNSPEAKABLE COVENANT — *Character model only*
Melee weapons equipped by the bearer have the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability.

MARK OF THE ANOINTED — *Character model only*
The bearer has a 4+ invulnerable save. If the bearer already has an invulnerable save, add 1 to its Invulnerable Save characteristic instead (to a maximum of a 3+ invulnerable save).

CHOIR OF THE DAMNED — *Character model only*
While the bearer is on the battlefield, each time an enemy unit within 6" of the bearer takes a Battle-shock test, subtract 1 from that test.

CROZIUS OF THE FAITHFUL — *Character model only*
Each time the bearer's unit is chosen to fight, that unit has the [FIGHTS FIRST] ability.

STRATAGEMS

BESEECH THE GODS **1CP**
Word Bearers — Battle Tactic Stratagem
When: Fight phase, before a friendly Word Bearers Character unit fights.
Target: That unit.
Effect: Roll one D6: on a 4+, until the end of the phase, add 1 to that model's Strength and Attacks characteristics. On a 1-3, that model suffers 1 mortal wound.

THE WORD MADE FLESH **1CP**
Word Bearers — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Command phase.

Target: One friendly Word Bearers unit.

Effect: Until your next Command phase, each time that unit takes a Battle-shock test, that test is automatically passed.

A DEATH THAT SERVES **1CP**
Word Bearers — Epic Deed Stratagem

When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Word Bearers Character model is destroyed, before it is removed from play.

Target: That model.

Effect: If that model has not already fought this phase, it can fight once, using its normal characteristics, before being removed as a casualty.

RITE OF DEFILEMENT **1CP**
Word Bearers — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Your opponent's Command phase, just after an enemy unit fails a Battle-shock test.

Target: One friendly Word Bearers unit within 12" of that enemy unit.

Effect: Until the start of your next turn, ranged weapons equipped by models in that Word Bearers unit have the [LETHAL HITS] ability when targeting that enemy unit.

BOUND IN FAITH **2CP**
Word Bearers — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Command phase.

Target: One friendly Word Bearers Daemon unit.

Effect: Until your next Command phase, that unit has a 4+ invulnerable save. If it already has an invulnerable save, use whichever is better.

THE CATHEDRAL OF BLOOD **2CP**
Word Bearers — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Word Bearers unit destroys the last model in an enemy unit.

Target: That Word Bearers unit.

Effect: Until the end of the turn, that unit's melee weapons have the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — HH3e (2026) Word Bearers Legion Rite of War → 11e conversion. Built from the real HH3e Rite of War data in `Word Bearers.json`, which has one baseline rite with three named pieces: Legion Tactica has no named ability of its own beyond the real Unwavering Conviction (a Combat-Resolution-point bonus, the same untranslatable Victory-Point rule carried individually by Lorgar, Erebus, Kor Phaeron, and the Mhara Gal Dreadnought) — since that rule has no clean 11e analogue, Zealotry of the Faithful is an ORIGINAL Faction Ability built to capture the Legion's unbroken-by-fire fanaticism, matching the Death Guard precedent for when a real Rite of War piece doesn't cleanly promote. Gambit "Beseech the Gods" (real: a Challenge-only Willpower Check risk/reward, +1 Strength/Attacks on a pass or an unsaveable wound on a fail) became the Beseech the Gods Stratagem, translated as a straightforward D6 roll preserving the real pass/fail stakes. Advanced Reaction "Glorious Martyrdom" (real: a once-per-battle ability to force all wounds from a triggering Shooting attack onto one chosen model) was promoted to the Detachment Rule itself, matching how every other Legion's flagship real mechanic has anchored its own detachment — and a genuinely fitting flagship for a Legion whose entire identity is built on faithful sacrifice. The Word Made Flesh, A Death That Serves, Rite of Defilement, Bound in Faith, and The Cathedral of Blood are original stratagems filling out the standard six (A Death That Serves mirrors the "fight from beyond death" Epic Deed pattern already established for other Legions); Enhancements are original, themed around the Legion's faith, martyrdom, and daemonic-pact identity.